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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION March 2026

FOURTH SEMESTER

SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC) – MG4SECPSY200 – UPSKILL SELF

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Question

Answer all questions

Each question carries 2 marks

1. One major obstacle to listening is: [K] / [CO1]

   Answer: b) Prejudging

2. PFA mainly promotes: [U] / [CO2]

   Answer: b) Coping and functioning

3. Which factor most influences body perception during adolescence? [E] / [CO3]

   Answer: b) Puberty and peer comparison

4. The phase where the disaster actually occurs is called: [U] / [CO2]

   Answer: b) Impact

5. Getting adequate sleep before exams mainly helps by: [An] / [CO3]

   Answer: b) Improving cognitive function

6. One psychological benefit of accepting individual differences is: [U] / [CO1]

   Answer: c) Improved mental health

7. Reducing intense emotional reactions is part of: [U] / [CO2]

   Answer: b) Calmness

8. Stressors that come from the environment are called: [K] / [CO3]

   Answer: c) External stressors

9. People usually engage in downward comparison when: [U] / [CO1]

   Answer: b) Their self-esteem is threatened

10. Which response avoids false reassurance? [A] / [CO2]

    Answer: b) "This must be hard for you"

11. Research suggests that boosting already inflated self-esteem may: [U] / [CO1]

    Answer: c) Be misguided

12. Identifying safety concerns belongs to: [U] / [CO2]

    Answer: a) Look

13. Planning an outline before writing an essay helps because it: [U] / [CO3]

    Answer: b) Organizes ideas clearly

14. A teacher reduces bullying by encouraging empathy and conflict resolution skills. This approach focuses on: [A] / [CO3]

    Answer: c) Prevention through skill-building

15. When someone cries and you also feel sad because of their sadness, this reflects: [A] / [CO1]

    Answer: b) Affective empathy

Part B

ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

16. Explain the concept of empathy and describe its three types with examples. [An] / [CO1]

Definition of empathy: Ability to emotionally understand another person's feelings and perspective. Importance in helping relationships. Types of Empathy: Cognitive Empathy - Understanding another person's feelings logically, Example. Affective Empathy - Feeling the emotions of another person, Example. Compassionate Empathy - Understanding + feeling + willingness to help. Example. Role of empathy in improving communication and emotional safety.

17. Explain who Psychological First Aid (PFA) is meant for. Describe the groups of people who may benefit from PFA. [U] / [CO2]

Psychological First Aid (PFA) is an evidence-informed, humane, and supportive initial response to a fellow human being who is suffering after a crisis event and may need support. It is designed for anyone who has been exposed to a serious crisis event. The core principle of PFA is to provide practical care and support in a non-intrusive manner, without being intrusive or pathologizing the person's distress. The groups of people who may benefit from PFA are diverse and include: Survivors of Natural Disasters, Survivors of Human-Induced Disasters, Victims of Violence and Assault, Children and Adolescents, First Responders and Aid Workers , Individuals Who Have Lost Loved Ones and Community Members in the Aftermath of a Crisis. Explain each one. Mention examples.

18. List the causes of exam anxiety. [K] / [CO3]

Exam anxiety is a combination of physiological over-arousal, tension, and somatic symptoms, along with worry, dread, and fear of failure, that occur before or during test situations. Causes - Fear of Failure, Lack of Preparation, Past Poor Performance, High Expectations and Pressure, Low Self-Esteem and Self-Efficacy, Poor Time Management and

Study Skills, Test-Taking Conditions, Physiological Factors - Not getting enough sleep, poor nutrition, and lack of physical activity etc. Explain each cause with suitable example.

19. **A student who was a top performer in school now feels average in college. Using concepts of self-concept and social comparison, explain why this change occurred and how the student can improve their self-view.** [A] / [CO1]

Define self - concept, self – comparison. Leon Festinger's- Social Comparison Theory can be used to substantiate the answer. This situation shows how changes in the social environment influence self-concept. In school, the student saw himself/herself as a "top performer" because he/she compared their performance to the classmates. In college, the comparison group changed to other high-achieving students, leading to upward social comparison, which made the student feel average.

Some points to improving self-view:

- Focus on personal growth instead of comparing with others.
- Develop a broader self-concept through different activities.
- Adopt a growth mindset and see challenges as learning opportunities.
- Set personal and process-oriented goals.